is unlikely to have been an *'idgah*: remains of columns in *both* phases of the building indicate that it was roofed (cf. Schlumberger 1978: 67–79 and pls. 23, 93–96). Nevertheless, it is of course possible that the simple, open-air prayer area comprising an *'idgah* was a known architectural type in Khurasan, and that examples pre-dating the fourteenth century both in Iran and India have tended not to survive precisely due to their meager physical "footprints" – as would have been the case at Jam-Firuzkuh. For a no longer extant Tughluq-period (mid-fourteenth century) *'idgah* at Multan, cf. A. N. Khan 1983: 177.

34. In her analysis of architectural descriptions in the panegyric poetry (*qasida*) produced at the Ghaznavid and Saljuq courts, Meisami (2001: 30, 41–42) highlighted the growing abstraction in poetic references to palaces; over time the poetry contained fewer descriptive details, increasingly substituted with metaphors and rhetorical flourishes by the mid-twelfth century. By way of explanation, she proposed both a broadening base of patronage beyond royalty to the religious and military elites, and an attendant shift in the very function of the palace from a forum of artistic creativity to a display trophy. The less than illustrious origins of the Shansabanis not only called for all the royal symbolism and legitimation of power that could be mustered, their chronicler Juzjani was heir to the poetic-literary traditions of the literati patronized by the Ghaznavids and Saljuqs. Understandably, then, his architectural descriptions served largely symbolic rather than documentary purposes.
35. Cf. esp. Flood 2002 for the historical and modern meanings of the Bamiyan Buddhas' destruction; for Bamiyan's "posthumous" designation as a UNESCO site, see Manhart 2006. See Inaba 2019 for the changing receptions of Bamiyan's Buddhas from the tenth through nineteenth centuries.
36. Cited by Tarzi 2007: 98. See also Thomas 2018: 58–59; Ball 2019: No. 100, for a thorough bibliography.
37. Cf. de Planhol (1988); Klimburg-Salter 1989: 10–11; Ball 2008: 164–173; Lorain 2018. This conception of the Bamiyan basin also emerges from Baker and Allchin's (1991) excavations at Shahr-i Zuhak and related sites (see *infra* in main text), and from Lee's (2006) documentation of the historical fortifications in western Bamiyan Province. For Funduqistan, Fuladi, and Kakrak, see also Ball 2019: Nos. 330, 332, 508, respectively.
38. Manhart 2006: 49; Tarzi 2007: 97, 107, 118ff.; Klimburg-Salter 2008: 132, 135, 140. Ball, Bordeaux et al. (2019: 391 and notes) espouse a date of the mid-seventh century for the Buddhas, however.
39. Cf. Rezakhani 2017: 141–142, and *ibid.*, 164–165 for a brief discussion of these debates. See also Tarzi 2007: 121–122; Crossley 2019: 50–53.
40. Klimburg-Salter 2008: 151.
41. Ball (2020) reiterated Klimburg-Salter's (1989: 134–136) earlier assertion. For the major site of Qunduz (along with associated mounds in the vicinity), see Ball 2019: Nos. 194, 569, 930, 931, 1160. Such a politico-dynastic geography would be continuous with that of the Kushanas (first–fourth centuries CE), whose political base was at Bagram but lavish patronage was dedicated to their dynastic center of Surkh Khotal. Cf. also Ball 2019: Nos.